

Boston Sunday Globe

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For college essay, a few words best left unsaid?

Careful phrasing in an age of DEI bans

By Brooke Hauser
GLOBE STAFF

Mo Marie Lauyanne Kouame, 18, dreams of being an aerospace engineer and building spacecraft. This fall, she applied to MIT, Princeton, and Columbia.

For one college essay, she wrote about being homeless at 8 years old, when she came to the United States from France.

She recalled watching her parents fight for help from the Department of Transitional Assistance and sleeping in hospital beds at Boston Medical Center when they didn't know where else to go. That early experience changed her, she said.

"Homelessness," she wrote, "taught me resilience."

Kouame's essay, which recounts how she learned to thrive as a low-income student of color "surrounded by classmates whose lives felt worlds apart from mine," is about overcoming adversity.

That's a theme the White House has identified as a problem in its campaign against diversity, equity, and inclusion.

ESSAYS, Page A16

Epstein's hidden hand in professor's poetry show

Even employees did not know of his role

By Tricia L. Nadolny
and Deirdre Fernandes
GLOBE STAFF

In the fall of 2013, prominent Harvard professor Elisa New filmed a short interview with the controversial movie director Woody Allen in which they debated a poem about a man eating plums.

The footage was unpolished but lively, and destined to eventually be part of a course at Harvard as well as New's affiliated public television show, "Poetry in America."

As a professor and the wife of famed economist and former Harvard president Lawrence Summers, New was used to rubbing elbows with the wealthy and famous, from Bill Clinton to Yo-Yo Ma. But landing the sitdown with Allen was a feat, one New accomplished only with the quiet backing of one of the director's close friends, convicted sex offender Jeffrey Epstein.

At the time, Epstein had served a sentence for soliciting a minor for prostitution and had been banned from do-

EPSTEIN, Page A17

2 killed, 9 hurt in shooting at Brown

Police seek assailant after attack at building on Providence campus

This story was reported by Dan McGowan, Edward Fitzpatrick, Omar Mohammed, Amanda Kaufman, Camilo Fonseca, Laura Crimaldi, Steph Machado, and Carlos Munos, and written by Nick Stoico, all of the Globe staff.

PROVIDENCE — A gunman

was still at large after a shooting at Brown University during final exams Saturday afternoon that killed two students and wounded nine other people and triggered a lockdown for the Ivy League campus and the busy neighborhood around it.

Little information about the shooter was immediately avail-

able. Late Saturday, police released an 11-second video showing a person of interest, whom they described as a male dressed in black clothing. He is shown walking down Hope Street and rounding a corner after leaving the scene of the shooting around 4:05 p.m., but his face is not visible in the video.

Timothy O'Hara, deputy chief of the Providence Police Department, said the suspect "could be

BROWN, Page A20



ERIN CLARK/GLOBE STAFF

Police officers patrolled a street near Brown University Saturday night.



ERIN CLARK/GLOBE STAFF

FIRST IN A TWO-PART SERIES.

Rümeysa Öztürk, an American story

In March, masked ICE agents swarmed the Turkish grad student on a Somerville street. Trump's crackdown on foreign scholars was just beginning.

BY GIULIA MCDONNELL NIETO DEL RIO
AND MARK ARSENAULT | GLOBE STAFF

The agents arrived in the darkness before dawn.

At 5:44 a.m. on March 25, 2025, a silver Dodge Charger rolled up quietly from the north, into a slumbering Somerville neighborhood near Tufts University. The driver pulled over on Mason Street, near its intersection with Electric Avenue, and backed up tight to the curb. He killed the headlights, stepped out of the car, and took a last tug on his cigarette. He flicked it into the street.

Six minutes later, according to a time-stamped home security video, the driver of an unmarked SUV parked in front of the Charger, facing the same direction, as if to maintain good sightlines to the subject of the stakeout. He was dressed in khakis and a cap on a chilly Tuesday morning. He carried a coffee cup — it was going to be a long day.

But the agents had their orders. They were from the Department of Homeland Security assigned to find and detain Rümeysa Öztürk, a 30-year-old Tufts University graduate student from Turkey. Getting

ÖZTÜRK, Page A18

Rümeysa Öztürk, a doctoral student at Tufts University, spent more than six weeks in ICE detention.

Torment and trial | The final chapter

Latarsha Sanders was convicted of killing her children, even though she was experiencing severe symptoms of mental illness. This series, which ends today, explores what led up to that horrific killing, and how the justice system treated Sanders and her family afterward. **B1.**



Bostonians of the Year chose a difficult path and showed us what strength looks like. **Globe Magazine.**

Private historic homes open to the public for holiday house tours. **N1.**

Snow. It begins.

Sunday: Snow early. High: 31-36. Low: 15-20.
Monday: Cold. High: 28-33. Low: 20-25.
Sunrise: 7:06 Sunset: 4:12
Complete report, **B10.**
Deaths, **A21-26.**

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